

Psalms 30

Joy Comes in the Morning

Weeping may endure for a night, but joy cometh in the morning
KJV · Standalone study handout

1 · THE WORD (KJV)

- 1 *I will extol thee, O LORD; for thou hast lifted me up, and hast not made my foes to rejoice over me.*
- 2 *O LORD my God, I cried unto thee, and thou hast healed me.*
- 3 *O LORD, thou hast brought up my soul from the grave: thou hast kept me alive, that I should not go down to the pit.*
- 4 *Sing unto the LORD, O ye saints of his, and give thanks at the remembrance of his holiness.*
- 5 *For his anger endureth but a moment; in his favour is life: weeping may endure for a night, but joy cometh in the morning.*
- 6 *And in my prosperity I said, I shall never be moved.*
- 7 *LORD, by thy favour thou hast made my mountain to stand strong: thou didst hide thy face, and I was troubled.*
- 8 *I cried to thee, O LORD; and unto the LORD I made supplication.*
- 9 *What profit is there in my blood, when I go down to the pit? Shall the dust praise thee? shall it declare thy truth?*
- 10 *Hear, O LORD, and have mercy upon me: LORD, be thou my helper.*
- 11 *Thou hast turned for me my mourning into dancing: thou hast put off my sackcloth, and girded me with gladness;*
- 12 *To the end that my glory may sing praise to thee, and not be silent. O LORD my God, I will give thanks unto thee for ever.*

2 · CONTEXT

Psalm 30, headed “a song at the dedication of the house of David,” is a thanksgiving for recovery from serious illness or near-death crisis, tracing a full arc from cry, through healing, warning against self-sufficient prosperity, back through renewed distress, and finally into settled, dancing joy. Henry highlights the psalm’s honest admission of past presumption (“I shall never be moved”) exposed by later trouble, making its closing praise all the more grounded in real, tested experience rather than untested optimism.

3 · VERSE-BY-VERSE COMMENTARY

The notes below cover the whole chapter in one place—read with the KJV text above.

Verse 1-3

Praise for being lifted up, healed, and kept from going down to the pit—God’s anger contrasted with His restoring favor. The crisis was apparently severe, framed almost as rescue from death itself.

Verse 4-5

A call to the “saints” to give thanks and sing at the remembrance of God’s holiness, paired with the psalm’s central insight: God’s anger is momentary, His favor lasts a lifetime; weeping may last a night, but joy comes in the morning.

Verse 6-7

Honest confession of past presumption: “In my prosperity I said, I shall never be moved,” trusting the “mountain” of settled favor as permanent—until God, for a season, hid His face and trouble followed.

Verse 8-10

Renewed crying out to the Lord for mercy, with an argument echoing Psalm 6: what profit is there in death, since the dust cannot praise or declare God’s truth—an appeal to God’s own glory as motive for mercy.

Verse 11-12

A joyful resolution: mourning turned into dancing, sackcloth exchanged for gladness—so that David’s “glory,” his very being, might sing praise without silence, giving thanks to the Lord forever.

4 · MEANING & APPLICATION

Meaning.

Painful seasons, even ones exposing past presumption, are not the final word; God’s momentary displeasure gives way to lasting favor, and honest lament regularly turns into lasting, grateful praise.

Application for life today.

If you are in a season of “weeping,” let this psalm give you permission to expect morning without denying the reality of the night. Examine your own history for a “prosperity” moment where you assumed stability was guaranteed (“I shall never be moved”)—let past correction humble present confidence rather than breed cynicism. And when God does turn mourning into dancing in your

life, follow David’s pattern of vocal, specific, lasting thanksgiving rather than quiet relief that fades.

5 · REFLECT & RESPOND

Write your answers in the space below. There are no “right length” answers—honesty before God is the aim.

1. What season of “weeping” are you currently in, and how does the promise of “joy... in the morning” speak to it?

2. Where have you, like David, presumed on stability (“I shall never be moved”) only to be humbled later?

3. How can you turn a recent answered prayer into the kind of vocal, lasting thanksgiving described in verses 11–12?

Name: _____ Date: _____ Group / Church: _____

Sources: King James Version (public domain); Matthew Henry, Commentary on the Whole Bible (themes summarized); Expository themes consistent with MacArthur Study Bible tradition (paraphrased, not quoted). Scripture: King James Version (public domain).